

The functional-shortcut-reliance ladder (no L1 → L5/L6 leap)

predictor side {L1-L4}

L1

Detectability

can D be decoded from $Z|Y$?

L2

Reducibility

does a method reduce measured leakage?

L3

Erasability

can an eraser remove the subject signal?

L4

Task coupling

is the subspace aligned with the task head?

L5

Functional reliance

does removing it change the output?

L6

Target consequence

harmful / benign / task-useful?

RQ1/RQ3

RQ2

endpoint side {L5, L6}